

INTAKE-ARBITER -- FREE-COOLING DECISION REPORT

Data centres over-cool, continuously, because nobody can promise them the hours ahead. A chiller plant needs hours of notice to change mode, and a thermometer only ever reports NOW -- so the mechanical chillers keep running through hours that outside air could have cooled for free. FortyGuard closes that gap with heat intelligence 2 m above the ground, the height a ground-mounted condenser actually breathes. This agent turns that forecast into an hour-by-hour schedule carrying a calibrated safety bound.

THE SITE

Location Switch: The Rock, TX -- station KATT, America/Chicago
Building OSM 1493169641
Switch: The Rock
Facade gap not applicable -- one building, no second facade
Weather record 42,281 real hourly records from KATT
Plume physics NOT MODELLED. No other tagged data centre lies inside the solver's validated range, so there is no neighbour intake for a plume to arrive at: the quantity does not exist here rather than being unmeasured. This is a statement about the model's domain, not a claim that recirculation here is zero. A building's own exhaust re-entering its own intake is not modelled at any site in this project.

FortyGuard data: weather and geometry are this site's own; the four measured FortyGuard level offsets and the N-26 coverage record are Ashburn's, because only Ashburn has forecast/outcome day pairs. Quote the hours for this site; quote the coverage for Ashburn.

THIS REPORT IS A SNAPSHOT, NOT THE LIVE PAGE

The interface recomputes the decision for whatever configuration a reader selects. This file was generated at build time for the ONE configuration named below, chosen because it is the configuration in which this site's agent does the most while still changing mode at least once. If the numbers on screen differ from the numbers here, the configuration differs -- compare the two lists before concluding anything else.

Day 2021-01-01 (recirc_edge)
Plant limit 18.0 C
Notice required 6 h
Forecast skill 0.00 relative to persistence
Level anchor sensor
Condenser bank longest facade
Switch budget 2 mode changes per day
Minimum dwell 3 h
Max dew point 15.0 C (Green Grid WP#46 p.6)

WHAT THE AGENT DID ON THIS DAY

The agent ran free cooling for 13 of 24 hours with 2 mode changes. 9 hours were safe but still ran chillers, because the schedule could not afford them.

Agent 13 of 24 hours free cooling, 2 mode change(s), 0 unsafe hour(s)
Incumbent 13 of 24 hours free cooling, 2 mode change(s), 0 unsafe hour(s)
9 hour(s) passed every gate and still ran chillers, because the schedule could not afford them

EVERY HOUR, AND THE REASON FOR IT

hh	mode	safe	binding	bound	limit	actual	margin
00	FREE	yes	-	1.120	18.0	2.780	3.812
01	FREE	yes	-	1.670	18.0	2.780	3.636
02	FREE	yes	-	2.220	18.0	2.780	3.517
03	FREE	yes	-	2.230	18.0	2.780	3.012

04	FREE	yes	-	2.780	18.0	3.330	3.031
05	FREE	yes	-	2.780	18.0	3.330	2.542
06	FREE	yes	-	2.780	18.0	3.330	2.093
07	FREE	yes	-	3.340	18.0	4.440	1.803
08	FREE	yes	-	5.560	18.0	5.560	2.128
09	FREE	yes	-	8.890	18.0	6.110	3.333
10	FREE	yes	-	12.220	18.0	7.780	4.012
11	FREE	yes	-	15.000	18.0	8.330	5.027
12	FREE	yes	-	16.670	18.0	9.440	5.245
13	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	18.330	18.0	11.670	5.211
14	mechanical	no	dry-bulb	18.330	18.0	11.670	4.815
15	mechanical	yes	-	16.110	18.0	11.110	3.582
16	mechanical	yes	switch budget	15.560	18.0	10.560	3.465
17	mechanical	yes	switch budget	13.330	18.0	9.440	3.122
18	mechanical	yes	switch budget	11.660	18.0	7.780	2.754
19	mechanical	yes	switch budget	11.670	18.0	6.670	2.677
20	mechanical	yes	switch budget	10.560	18.0	6.110	3.369
21	mechanical	yes	switch budget	9.440	18.0	5.560	3.861
22	mechanical	yes	switch budget	8.340	18.0	4.440	3.899
23	mechanical	yes	switch budget	7.770	18.0	3.890	4.312

bound = the agent's 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air, forecast plus margin
actual = what the intake temperature turned out to be, from the station record
margin = group-conditional forecast error for that hour of day, plus plume spread

THE REASONING, HOUR BY HOUR

00:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 1.120 C, which is 16.880 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 3.812 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 3.812 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

01:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 1.670 C, which is 16.330 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 3.636 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 3.636 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

02:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 2.220 C, which is 15.780 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 3.517 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 3.517 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

03:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 2.230 C, which is 15.770 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 3.012 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 3.012 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

04:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 2.780 C, which is 15.220 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 3.031 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 3.031 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

05:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 2.780 C, which is 15.220 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 2.542 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 2.542 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

06:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 2.780 C, which is 15.220 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 2.093 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 2.093 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

07:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 3.340 C, which is 14.660 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 1.803 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 1.803 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

08:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 5.560 C, which is 12.440 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 2.128 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 2.128 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

09:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 8.890 C, which is 9.110 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 3.333 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 3.333 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

10:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 12.220 C, which is 5.780 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 4.012 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 4.012 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

11:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 15.000 C, which is 3.000 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 5.027 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 5.027 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

12:00 FREE-COOLING

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 16.670 C, which is 1.330 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 5.245 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 5.245 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0000 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

13:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 18.330 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 0.330 C. It would take a limit 0.330 C higher, or a bound 0.330 C tighter, to change this hour.

14:00 MECHANICAL [dry-bulb]

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 18.330 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 0.330 C. It would take a limit 0.330 C higher, or a bound 0.330 C tighter, to change this hour.

15:00 MECHANICAL

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 16.110 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: no relaxation of either the switch budget or the dwell would free it, so the surrounding hours are worth more. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

16:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 15.560 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 2 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

17:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 13.330 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 2 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

18:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 11.660 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 2 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

19:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 11.670 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 2 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

20:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 10.560 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 2 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

21:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 9.440 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 2 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

22:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 8.340 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 2 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

23:00 MECHANICAL [switch budget]

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 7.770 C

against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 2 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

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